

A Practitioner's Guide to Moving to the CLOUD

Cloud computing is leading the IT transformation in a big way. Enterprises, irrespective of their size, are considering moving to the cloud as an integral part of their short term IT roadmap. Industry is at a state where embracing the cloud has become inevitable, since not doing so could lead to losing the competitive edge when operating at scale. At this juncture, businesses need to take cautious steps in their endeavour to migrate their workloads onto public clouds.



This article focuses on laying out guidelines that are essential for business decision-makers (BDMs) and technical decision-makers (TDMs). It aims to improve their knowhow about the cloud and, hence, facilitate better planning. Some aspects may have a direct impact on how a solution needs to be perceived in the context of the cloud. These guidelines help you revisit your 'IT Reference Blueprints' in the context of the cloud to address provisioning, management, latency, security, integration, redundancy, HA and other related aspects.

1. Fix the 'foundation' before moving ahead

At the point when you are deciding to migrate your solution to the cloud, it is essential to take a step back and understand if the built solution is cloud-ready. Companies that architect/design solutions keeping the public cloud under consideration will not be affected by this aspect, but it is critically relevant for the rest. In most cases, when solutions that already exist on premise are prepared to be moved to the public cloud, the base building blocks appear broken. This guideline is outside the purview of 'lift and shift' where you are essentially moving over 'boxes'.

Solutions are built and tweaked over a period of time considering the hosting and operating environment. However, when you want to migrate to leverage the scale and elasticity of the cloud,